Inpatient Notification and Prior Authorization Requirements – Quick Guide

NON-EMERGENCY ADMISSIONS		
Type of Benefit Plan	**Prior Authorization**	**Admission Notification**
AZ Blue Commercial Group and Individual/Family Plans	Required only for admissions related to codes that require prior authorization .	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required within 48 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Fax the face sheet to 844-263-2272 • Call 602-864-4320 or 800-232-2345
Certain Self-Funded Group Plans (prefixes PXO, SWB, SNK, SYD, S3Z, TYW)	Required for all non-emergency admissions except maternity admissions.	
ACA StandardHealth with Health Choice Plan (prefix IAZ)	Required.	Post-admission notification required within 24 hours: Call 1-800-322-8670.
Federal Employee Program® (FEP®) Plans (prefix R)	Precertification or prior approval required for all non-emergency admissions except maternity admissions for a routine delivery (stays longer than 48 hours after vaginal delivery or 96 hours after cesarean require precertification of the additional days).	Post-admission notification is always required within 48 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Call 602-864-4102 or 800-345-7562 • Postal service plans: 888-585-8922
Medicare Advantage Plans administered by AZ Blue	Required only for admissions related to codes that require prior authorization.	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required within 24 hours: • Online: Use the Availity portal • Fax: Use the MA Request Fax Form • Call 800-446-8331
Medicare Advantage Plans administered by Optum Health Network Arizona (OHNAZ) or Arizona Priority Care (AZPC)	Notification required within 24 hours (check prior authorization requirements): • For OHNAZ: Go to optumproportal.com/home or call 877-370-2845. • For AZPC: Fax to 480-499-8779 or call 480-499-8720.	
BlueCard® (Out-of-Area) Plans	Call the number on the back of the ID card (member's home Blue Plan).	
TPA-Administered Group Plans (prefixes K8Y, K8Z, MKQ, NBT, PTP)	Call the number on the back of the ID card (UM is administered by a TPA).	
Strategic Hub Plans w Blue Plan Partner (prefixes AOZ, AZI, AZK, IVR)	Use the Strategic Hub My Insurance Manager portal (or call 888-376-6544; Mental health/SUD: 800-868-1032).	

TRANSFERS TO DIFFERENT LEVELS OF CARE		
Type of Transfer	**Prior Authorization**	**Admission Notification**
Observation → Inpatient	N/A	When prior authorization is not required, pre-admission notification is required. Post-admission notification is always required (see above for time frame and notification options by type of plan).
Acute Care → Post-Acute Care	Required, except for plans eligible for our SNF Quick Transfer program (most commercial plans and the Medicare Advantage plans we administer).	
Acute Care Facility → Another Acute Care Facility (same or lower level of care)	Required.	
Different Levels of Care (within the same facility)	N/A	N/A